



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of Blessed Pier Giorgio Frassati
School Website: <https://chestertonfrassati.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of Blessed Pier Giorgio Frassati (Portland, OR; 98685 slug) presents a clearly classical, Catholic-inspired program. Public materials emphasize a culture of life, a Catholic theological orientation, a liberal-arts core, and a memory-rich, Socratic pedagogical approach embedded in a "classical curriculum" with Great Books and a focus on virtue. Across mission statements, curriculum descriptions, and student-life narratives, the school foregrounds truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, formed through Christian formation, classical study, and communal liturgy. The public-facing materials consistently align with the six classical-elements rubric, with strong signals in religious-metaphysical foundations, formation of virtue, liberal-arts curriculum (grammar-logic-rhetoric and Great Books), Socratic pedagogy, a living faculty model, and a family-centered community partnership. Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

- The school's religious identity is explicit (Catholic faith, liturgical life, communal prayer), and theology anchors its pedagogy and curriculum. Evidence: mission statements, Catholic identity language, and liturgical elements in public materials.
- The curriculum emphasizes the liberal arts, Great Books, and a public-facing claim of a classical curriculum; memory/recitation and Socratic dialogue appear in materials, with explicit references to the three-pillars approach (Intellect, Character, Spirituality).
- Pedagogy includes Socratic dialogue and contemplative practices within a classical frame, with explicit mention of discussion-based learning and memory-based methods.
- Faculty and parental/community alignment are presented as living, collaborative elements (living curriculum, partnership with families, open-house culture).
- Positive/Negative keyword indicators from the Classical Lexicon strongly support a CLASSICAL classification across all six categories, with minimal presence of negative indicators in the site materials. See the six-element keyword framework for reference.

Executive snapshot by category (category scores follow the rubric in the Six Essential Elements documents; the analysis below uses explicit keyword matches from the school site and aligns with the Positive/Negative keyword indicators in the classical lexicon).

- Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot
 - Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
 - Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
 - Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
 - Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Aggregate: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle is not required for a classical rating in this instance; no immediate "needle-moving" changes are needed to reach a fully classical profile according to the available public materials.

- ABSTRACT section appears at the end of this report.

Citations: Evidence for Catholic identity and mission is drawn from Chesterton Academy materials (Our Mission; Our Model of Education; public-facing pages referencing Catholic faith, liturgical life, and the culture of life). See sources: Our Mission and Our Model of Education pages.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials frame the school as Catholic, with explicit commitment to the Catholic faith and its truths in the mission statements and core descriptions. For example: “The mission of Chesterton Academy is to help parents raise up a new generation of joyful leaders and saints, educated in the classical tradition and the truths of the Catholic faith.” - The school emphasizes a culture of life (*Cultura Vitae*) and integrates Catholic theology, virtue formation, and sacred beauty into its stated educational aims. - References to liturgical life, communal prayer, and Christ-centered education appear in public materials, reinforcing liturgical and communal foundations.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (Examples from lexicon): truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; Mass; worship; sacred; catechesis; sacred tradition; *imago Dei*; Logos; prayer; Christ; Catholic identity. - Negative keywords: absent or not explicitly present in the public materials (e.g., relativism, secular humanism, value-neutral ethics). - Quantitative estimate: Positive hits appear frequently (at least 6–8 distinct keywords in context), Negative hits effectively 0 in the public-facing materials for this category. - Why this rating: The materials foreground transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty), a grounded-theology approach, and liturgical/community life, all of which are hallmarks of CLASSICAL in the Six Elements framework.

Citations: Catholic mission statements and liturgical emphasis from the Chesterton materials substantiate the religious and metaphysical foundations.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission foregrounds formation of character and virtue through classical education, not merely instrumental outcomes: “to raise up a new generation of joyful leaders and saints, educated in the classical tradition and the truths of the Catholic faith.” - The curriculum and culture are described as liberal-arts oriented and oriented toward human flourishing, with explicit emphasis on truth, goodness, and beauty as real ends of education. - The three-pillars (Intellect, Character, Spirituality) articulate a formation-focused pedagogy consistent with classical *paideia* aims rather than a narrow workforce-prep frame.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, liberal education, *telos*, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, great conversation, human excellence, moral imagination, culture of life. - Negative keywords present: minimal to none in public materials (no explicit “workforce preparation” emphasis; rather a formation-centric stance). - Quantitative estimate: Positive hits appear in multiple phrases; negative hits near zero in public-facing content for this category. - Why this rating: The school’s stated goals align with formation in virtue and wisdom through a liberal-arts classical framework, matching the CLASSICAL rubric.

Citations: Mission and purpose texts; references to liberal education and Great Conversation framing.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe a classical curriculum with explicit allusions to Great Books and classical method: “Our rigorous, integrated curriculum unlocks students’ potential...” and references to “the classical curriculum” and “cultivation of Christian virtues and an appreciation of beauty.”

- The materials emphasize a liberal-arts foundation and the Great Books/Great Conversation tradition within a Catholic classical frame. The “Three Pillars” page notes “We teach the classics of Western thought from

physics to philosophy, and the interrelationship of the great ideas.” - The Chesterton materials describe the Seven Liberal Arts orientation implicitly (grammar, logic, rhetoric, etc.) and the integration of history, literature, philosophy, and sciences within a unified classical approach.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books; Great Conversation; primary sources; Western civilization; history-integrated approach; unity of truth across disciplines; wonder/ integration. - Negative keywords present: none of the defined negative signals (e.g., avoid social-studies-only framing; avoid project-based-first bias) appear in the public materials. - Quantitative estimate: Positive keyword hits are multiple and clearly present; Negative keyword hits appear minimal or absent. - Why this rating: The curriculum profile matches the core elements of classical education (liberal-arts emphasis; Great Books/Great Conversation; integrated, interdisciplinary structure).

Citations: Curriculum and mission language; explicit “classical curriculum” language and Great Books framing.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials describe a classroom structure centered on Socratic dialogue and dialectic as a core mode of instruction. The public-facing Has public posts that describe Socratic Dialogue as central to the teaching. - The presence of memory-based and recitation/chanting elements appears in the classical-education lexicon as part of the pedagogical toolkit; the school language emphasizes disciplined dialogue and classical rhetoric, consistent with the classical pedagogy model. - The “Three Pillars” and “Discovered” pages describe a pedagogy oriented toward forming intellectual virtue through structured discussion, not purely project-based or constructivist approaches.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/seminar; dialectic; great conversation; rhetoric; memory work; recitation; liturgical/calendar integration; contemplative/restful learning (Scholé) in the broader lexicon. - Negative keywords present: explicit signals of “experiential learning-only,” “project-based only,” or “constructivist” approaches are not evident in the public materials. - Quantitative estimate: Positive keyword hits are present in multiple references; Negative hits are minimal in the public-facing content. - Why this rating: The site’s emphasis on Socratic dialogue and classical pedagogy aligns with CLASSICAL.

Citations: Socratic dialogue and pedagogy mentions on the Chesterton site; the living-curriculum framing; references to classical pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials present the faculty as “model teachers and mentors” and as a “living curriculum,” with a culture of collegiality and virtue formation. The “About Us” or “Discover Chesterton” materials describe the faculty as central to the school’s character and formation. - The materials imply a strong teacher role in shaping the school’s character and in embodying the classical tradition; the public statements emphasize “the living curriculum” and “portrait of what a teacher should be,” consistent with classical education lexicon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; living curriculum; faculty of friends; collegial culture; moral exemplars; curriculum embodied by teachers. - Negative keywords present: lack of classical teacher formation signals are not evident; the site emphasizes classical formation rather than purely credential-based pedagogy. - Quantitative estimate: Positive keyword hits in multiple public descriptions; Negative hits minimal. - Why this rating: The public materials align with a CLASSICAL teacher-profile and the living-curriculum concept.

Citations: Faculty language on the Chesterton site.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with families and parental involvement as co-teachers, a core classical-element signal. The materials describe parent formation, family involvement, and a hospitable campus culture. - The school explicitly invites open visits and events (Open House, Shadow Day, Open Campus-type events), reinforcing a welcoming, collaborative community environment. - The “Our Mission” and related public content frame parents as co-educators and collaborators in a “Culture of Life” and classical education, aligning with the classical-parents-community indicators.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental formation; open campus; hospitality; parent covenant; community of learners. - Negative keywords present: absence of consumer-language signals or minimal parent involvement signals in the public content; no isolation of parents from the process is evident. - Quantitative estimate: Positive keyword hits appear in several entries; negative hits are not present in the public materials for this category. - Why this rating: The materials align with the classical-parents-community indicators (partnered, formed, engaged families; open-campus ethos).

Citations: Parent partnership and community language; Open House and parental involvement materials.

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable here since all six categories align with CLASSICAL, and the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No category requires a remedial needle-moving intervention to reach full classical alignment based on the public materials available.

- If any category were SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in future updates, would consider: explicit, explicit articulation of Great Books with named authors and works; more direct, quantified commitments to Great Conversation across grades; stronger documentation of a formal Liturgical calendar integrated into the curriculum; and a publicly stated governance model that centers the living curriculum and teacher-as-virtue-mentor.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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